Ans. (b) The last line of the passage, "I find it oddly anachronistic that in today's culture there seems to be a widespread presumption that scientific and spiritual views are incompatible", provides the inference that science and faith can be mutually complementary. The correct option is (b).

Passage–4

Though I have discarded much of past tradition and custom, and am anxious that India should rid herself of all shackles that bind and contain her and divide her people, and suppress vast numbers of them, and prevent the free numbers of them, and prevent the free development of the body and the spirit; though I seek all this, yet I do not wish to cut myself off from that past completely. I am proud of that great inheritance that has been and is, ours and I am conscious that I too, like all of us, am a link in that unbroken chain which goes back to the dawn of history in the immemorial past of India.

4. The author wants India to rid herself of certain past bonds because

(a) he is not able to see the relevance of the past
(b) there is not much to be proud of
(c) he is not interested in the history of India
(d) they obstruct her physical and spiritual growth

Ans. (d) It can be inferred from the first line of the passage especially from the past "India should rid herself……..development of the body and the spirit".

Directions for the following 4 (four) items :
Read the following passage and answer the four items that follow. Your answers to these items should be based on the passage only.

Passage

It is no longer enough for us to talk about providing available for universal access to education. Making available schooling facilities is an essential prerequisite, but is insufficient to ensure that all children attend school and participate in the learning process. The school may be there, but children may not attend or they may drop out after a few months. Through school and social mapping, we must address the entire gamut of social, economic, cultural and indeed linguistic and pedagogic issues, factors that prevent children from weaker sections and disadvantaged groups, as also girls, from regularly attending and complementing elementary education. The focus must be on the poorest and most vulnerable since these groups are the most disempowered and at the greatest risk of violation or denial of their right to education.

The right to education goes beyond free and compulsory education to include quality education for all. Quality is an integral part of the right to education. If the education process lacks quality, children are being denied their right. The Right of Children to Free and Compulsory Education Act lays down that the curriculum should provide for learning through activities, exploration and discovery. This places an obligation and discovery. This places an obligation on us to change our perception of children as passive receivers of knowledge, and to move beyond the convention of using textbooks as the basis of examinations. The teaching-learning process must become stress-free; and a massive programme for curricular reform should be initiated to provide for a child-friendly learning system, that is more relevant and empowering. Teacher accountability systems and processes must ensure that children are learning, and that their right to learn in a child-friendly environment is not violated. Testing and assessment systems must be reexamined and redesigned to ensure that these do not force children to struggle between school and tuition centres, and bypass childhood.

5. According to the passage, which of the following is/are of paramount importance under the Right to Education?

1. Sending of children to school by all parents
2. Provision of adequate physical infrastructure in schools
3. Curricular reforms for developing child-friendly learning system

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

(a) 1 only (b) 1 and 2 only
(c) 3 only (d) None of the above

Ans. (c) According to the passage, of paramount importance under the right to education, curriculum reforms are extremely important to develop learner-friendly learning systems. Through the passage, it has been discussed by the author that providing school facilities is a necessary pre-requisite, but to ensure that all children go to school and participate in the process of learning. Hence, option (a), (b) and (d) are false only option (c) is true.

6. With reference to the above passage, the following assumptions have been made :

1. The Right to Education guarantees teachers' accountability for the learning process of children.
2. The Right to Education guarantees 100% enrolment of children in the schools.
3. The Right to Education intends to take full advantage of demographic dividend.

Which of the above assumptions is/are valid?

(a) 1 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (a) Statement (1) is true in the context of the above passage, hence option (a) is correct, right to education guarantees the responsibility of the teacher for the learning process of the children, that is, the teacher's responsibility systems and procedures must ensure that children are receiving education and their right to receive education a learner friendly environment is not being violated, therefore, under the right of children to free and compulsory education act, there should be a provision for education through curricular, investigation and discovery.

7. According to the passage, which one of the following is critical in bringing quality in education?

(a) Ensuring regular attendance of children as well as teachers in school
(b) Giving pecuniary benefits to teachers to motivate them
(c) Understanding the socio-cultural background of children
(d) Inculcating learning through activities and discovery

Ans. (d) According to the passage, inculcating learning through activity and discovery is crucial in bringing quality to education. In order to bring quality education, the right of children to free and compulsory education Act lays down that the curriculum should provide for learning through activity, exploration and discovery. Hence option (d) is correct.

8. What is the essential massage in this passage?

(a) The Right to Education now is a Fundamental Right.
(b) The Right to Education enables the children of poor and weaker sections of the society to attend schools.
(c) The Right to Free and Compulsory Education should include quality education for all.
(d) The Government as well as parents should ensure that all children attend schools.

Ans. (c) The essential message of the passage is that the right to free and compulsory education should include quality education for all because quality education is the last part of the right. If the education process lacks quality, then children are being deprived of their right and the and the compulsory education Act mandates that the attitude of viewing children as passive recipients of learning should be changed and going beyond the practice of using textbooks as the basis for examinations, hence the inclusion of quality education is absolutely essential.

Direction for the following 7 (seven) items :
Read the following four passages and answer the two items that follow. Your answers to these items should be based on the passages only.

Passage–1

'Desertification' is a term used to explain a process of decline in the biological productivity of an ecosystem, leading to total loss of productivity. While this phenomenon is often linked to the arid, semi-arid and sub-humid ecosystems, even in the humid tropics, the impact could be most dramatic. Impoverishment of human-impacted terrestrial ecosystems may exhibit itself in a variety of ways : accelerated erosion as in the mountain regions of the country, salinization of land as in the semi-arid and arid 'green revolution' western Uttar Pradesh, and site quality decline–a common phenomenon due to general decline in tree cover and monotonous monoculture of rice/wheat across the Indian plains. A major consequence of deforestation is that it relates to adverse alterations in the hydrology and related soil and nutrient losses. The consequences of deforestation invariably arise out of site degradation through erosive losses. Tropical Asia, Africa and South America have the highest levels of erosion. The already high rates for the tropics are increasing at an alarming rate (e.g., through the major river systems–Ganga and Brahmaputra, in the Indian context), due to deforestation and ill-suited land management practices subsequent to forest clearing. In the mountain context, the declining moisture retention of the mountain soils, drying up of the underground springs and smaller rivers in the Himalayan region region could be attributed to drastic changes in the forest cover. An indirect consequence is drastic alteration in the upland-lowland interaction, mediated through water. The current concern the tea planter of Assam has is about the damage to tea plantations due to frequent inundation along the flood-plains of Brahmaputra, and the damage to tea plantation and the consequent loss in tea productivity is due to rising level of the river bottom because of siltation and the changing course of site desertification are soil degradation, alteration in available water and its quality, and the consequent decline in food, fodder and fuel-wood yields essential for the economic well-being of rural communities.

9. According to the passage, which of the following are the consequences of decline in forest cover?

1. Loss of topsoil
2. Loss of smaller rivers
3. Adverse effect on agricultural production
4. Declining of groundwater

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

(a) 1, 2 and 3 only (b) 2, 3 and 4 only
(c) 1 and 4 only (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Ans. (d) All the given options are the consequences of decline is forest cover; these can be inferred from the following lines of the passage- "leading to total loss of productivity", "accelerated erosion as in the mountain regions of the country", "adverse alternations in the hydrology and related soil and nutrient losses" and "drying up of the underground springs and smaller rivers in the Himalayan region……."

10. Which of the following is/are the correct inference/inferences that can be made from the passage?

1. Deforestation can cause changes in the course of rivers.
2. Salinization of land takes place due to human activities only.
3. Intense monoculture practice in plains is a major reason for desertification in Tropical Asia, Africa and South America.